LESSON 8

London Bridge

An old English singing game: two children make a bridge with their arms, and it falls down on whoever is passing under.

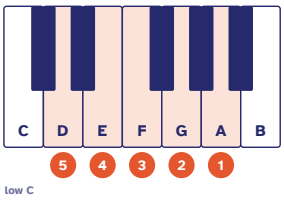
IN THIS SONG **the left hand has the tune** **rests: knock!** **no letters now**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

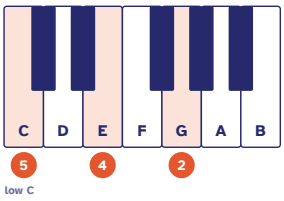
1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it, and knock on every rest. Then the left hand plays it while the right hand knocks.

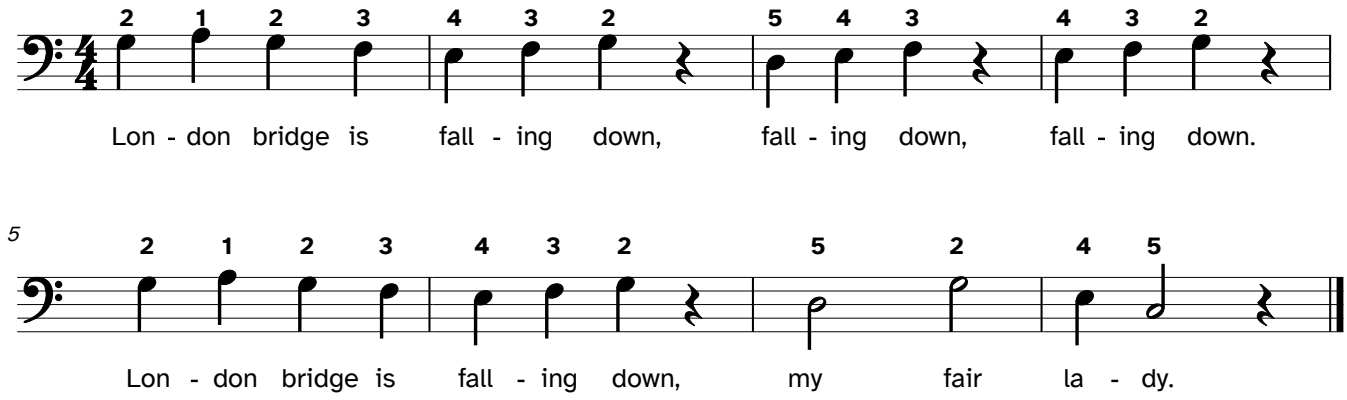
LEFT HAND · THUMB ON A



THE LAST NOTE · 5 REACHES DOWN TO C



Left hand: on the King's staff, an octave below middle C. Thumb on A, so G is 2, F 3, E 4, D 5.
My fair la-dy: 5 reaches down from D to C for the last note.
Right hand: knocks on the lid on every rest.



THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **The knock:** on every rest the right hand knocks on the piano's lid. The silence becomes part of the music, and the bridge really falls.

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Knocked on every rest** ☐ **Played it with the knocks**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

NEW IN THIS SONG

Rests. A crotchet rest is one beat of silence: count it, but don't play. Here the right hand knocks on every rest. **No letters now:** the notes are read from the staff.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones, and on a rest's grey number knock instead.

THE TIME

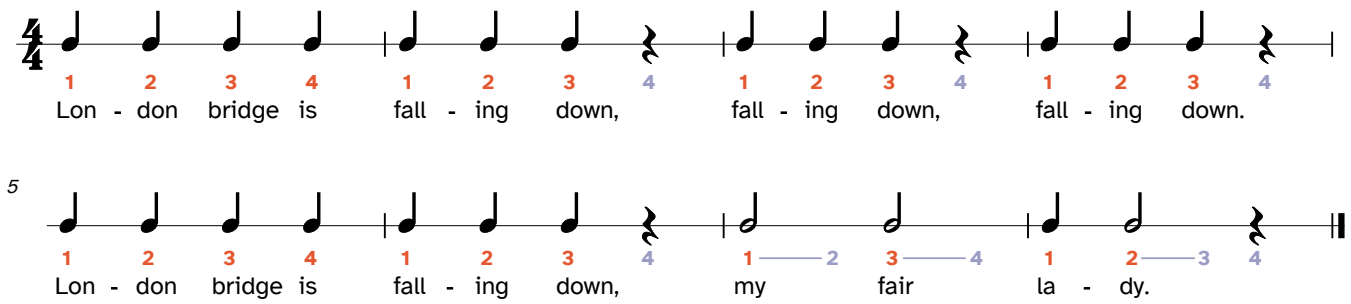
Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk — 1 beat ●

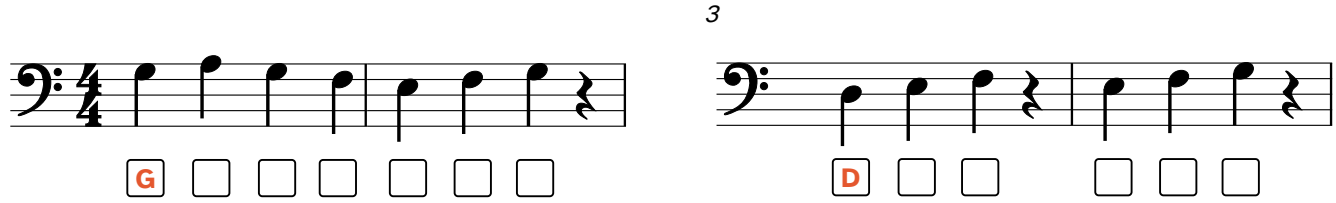
crotchet rest: knock — 1 beat ●

minim: hold — 2 beats ●●



THE NOTES

The letters are gone now. The first note of each line is given: count up or down from it on the King's staff.



SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays the song and forgets one rest (or adds one). Put up your hand when you hear it.

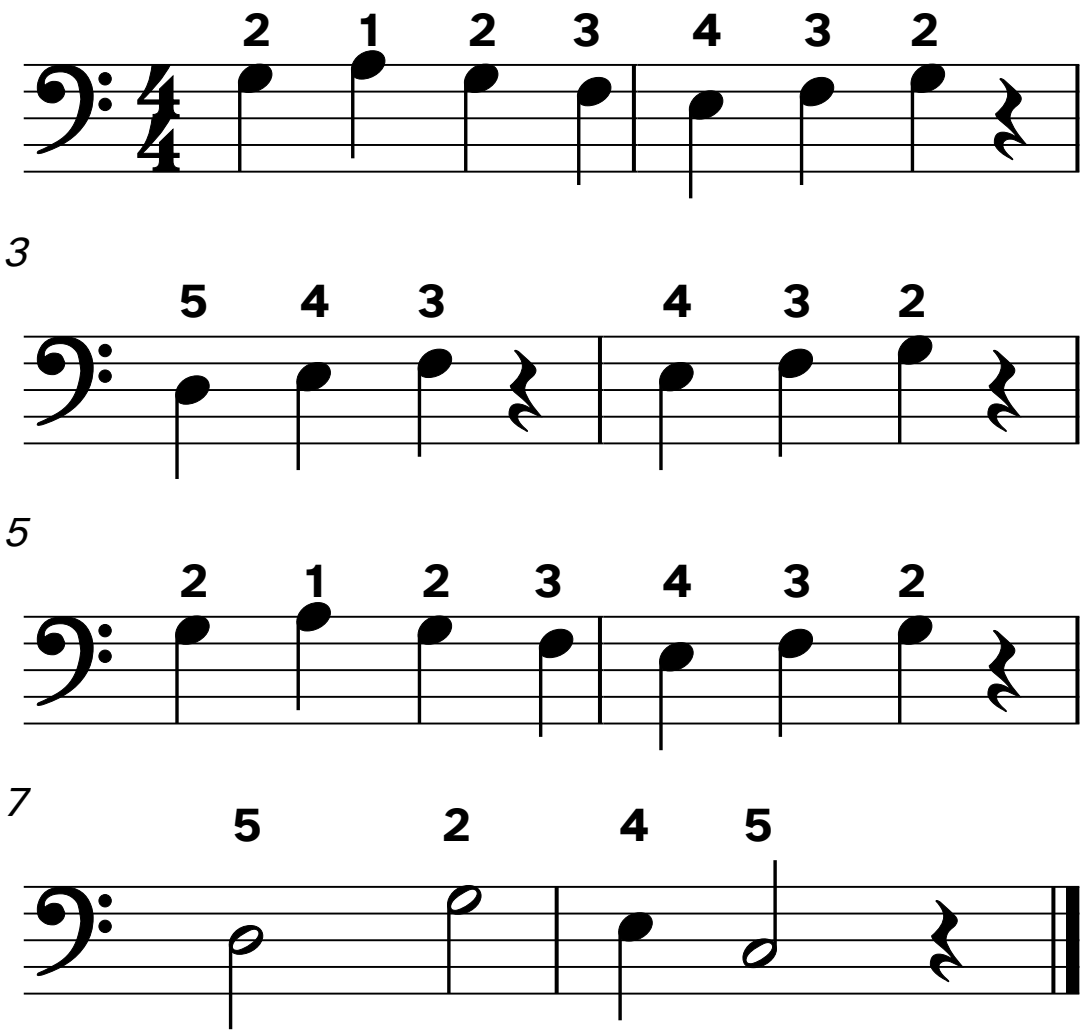
- ☐ **Said it in time**
- ☐ **Clapped and counted**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

3 Play it

The left hand plays the whole song; the right hand knocks on every rest.

Left hand: thumb on A, an octave below middle C (the keyboards on page 1); 5 reaches down to C at the end.

L **LEFT HAND** the whole song, with the knocks



4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can count the rests

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	Slowly	Steady	With the band	Fast
Left hand				
With the knocks				

TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

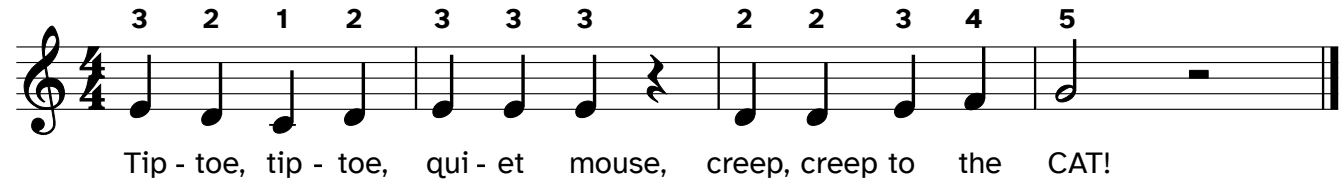
KNOCK, KNOCK

Cheeky: the left hand in the C position, 5 on low C, and a knock on every rest.



TIPTOE

A peek at Lesson 9: soft, softer... then the last note loud.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Falling slowly: slow and soft**
- ☐ **Bouncy: short and light, like a ball**
- ☐ **Down low: an octave lower**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Left hand with the knocks, twice
3. Play it with the band
4. Your choice: a tune from this page

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Knock, Knock** ☐ **Played Tiptoe**